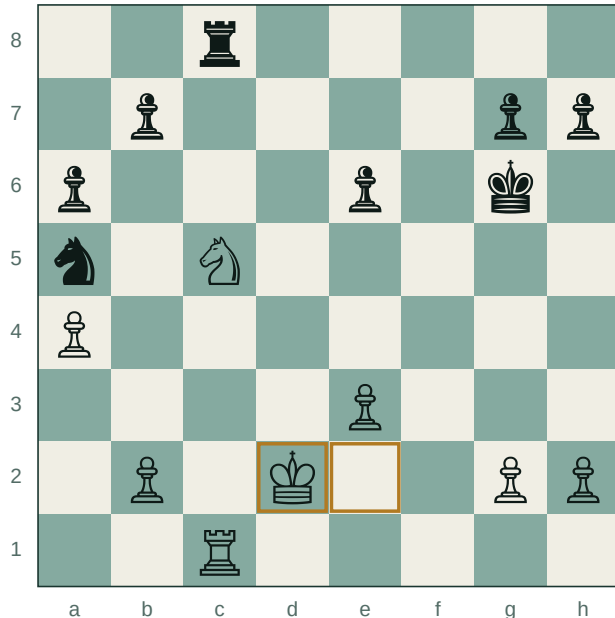


Attraction tactics: Black, move 26

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Kd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Rxc5 27. Rxc5 Nb3+ 28. Kc3 Nxc5

26...Rxc5 The rook captures the knight on c5. Recorded reply: **27.Rxc5**.

27...Nb3+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From b3 it attacks king on d2 and rook on c5. Recorded reply: **28.Kc3**.

28...Nxc5 The knight captures the rook on c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on d2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.